



as Desktop, Start Menu, Executables and Monitored. Clicking on a category scans all the files in that list, after which you can select a file or executable to be uninstalled. The program will run in the background, and find the related files and registry values. Then, it shows a screen containing a list of all the files pertaining to the application. Select the files to be removed, and click Next.

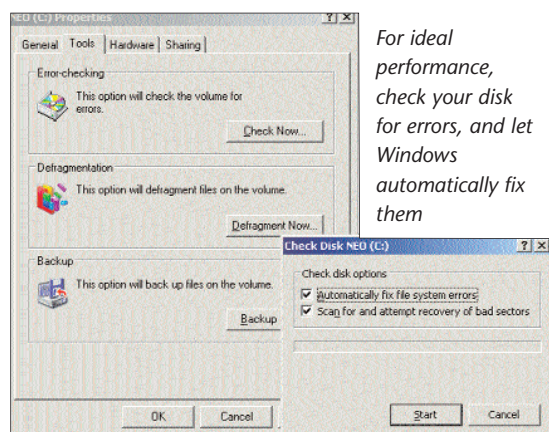
You will see an alert with SafeSelect enabled—this is a backup of all the files that are to be removed. Depending on whether or not you want to backup the file or program, select or de-select this option, and press Next. Click Done when finished. You can also remove files from other categories in a similar fashion.

In-house maintenance

The first thing you should do is create a swap file partition on a drive other than the one where Windows is installed. This way you'll ensure better performance, and also not risk corrupting your hard drive. Back up your data on another hard disk—if you don't have one, use a friend's.

ScanDisk (Windows 95, 98 and Me): Before running Scandisk, close all other applications using their 'close' commands,

For ideal performance, check your disk for errors, and let Windows automatically fix them



and not through 'End task' in Task Manager. Now, open My Computer, right-click on your C: drive and select Properties. Go to **Tools > Check Now**, select 'Automatically fix file system errors' and 'Scan for and attempt recovery of bad sectors', and click Start. After ScanDisk is done checking the drive, reboot your PC and repeat the process for all partitions and drives. In

the next time the computer starts. Reboot your computer, and let Scandisk run.

Disk defragmenter: After running Scandisk, you need to defragment your data. This makes your hard disk faster and more organized, and should ideally be done every 15 days.

To start this utility, go to **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Disk Defragmenter**, select the drive you want to defragment, and click Defragment. In Windows 98 or Me, set the utility to 'Rearrange files so my programs start faster' and 'Check the drive for errors', and set 'I want to use these options' to 'Every time I defragment my hard drive'. Windows will arrange your frequently used programs at the beginning of the drive, for faster access.

In Windows 2000 or XP, you get the option to Analyze or Defragment. Choose Analyze to see how fragmented the drive is, and you will be told whether defragmenting is required. If it is, click Defragment. You'll see a graphical representation of the process taking place. Do this for all your drives.

Third party Tools

Though heavy on your pocket, third-party disk utilities do a more precise job of maintenance than Windows does.

Norton Utilities: This is one of the most popular applications, and does a perfect job of hard disk maintenance. The suite features a module called Norton Disk Doctor that does a thorough job of correcting file errors.

Install Norton Disk Doctor, and start it by going to **Start > Programs > Norton SystemWorks > Norton Utilities > Find and Fix Problems > Norton Disk Doctor**. Press Continue, and select the drives you want to scan by ticking the boxes next to them. Click on Options; in the dialog that pops up, select 'Enable Free Space testing', and click OK. Finally, select 'Fix Errors' in the main screen, and press Diagnose to start checking your drives.

Speed Disk: Defragmenting using Speed Disk in Norton is easy. In Windows 98, start Speed Disk by going to **Start > Norton SystemWorks > Norton Utilities > Optimize Performance > Norton**